

Activity Guide — senior / module-02-panchabhuta

IKS Curriculum

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Activity 01 — Frameworks Comparison Table

Module: Pañcabhūta (Senior) · **Day:** 4 · **Time:** 25 min within Day 4's 45

Goal

Students fill in a structured comparison table contrasting Sāṅkhya, Greek (Empedocles + Aristotle), and modern frameworks across 7 dimensions.

Materials

- Printed comparison worksheet (one per student)
- Reading extracts on hand

Instructions

Working alone first, then with a buddy, fill in the table comparing the three frameworks.

For each cell, write a one-line answer. Where the framework has no equivalent, write “—” and we’ll discuss why in the next session.

Table (student-facing)

Dimension	Sāṅkhya	Greek (Empedocles + Aristotle)	Modern science
Number of elements			
Origin (eternal? emerge? created?)			
What drives combination			
Includes empty space?			
Includes			

Dimension	Sāṅkhya	Greek (Empedocles + Aristotle)	Modern science
consciousness?			
Perceptual mapping?			
Method (observation, experiment, philosophy)?			

Discussion (last 10 min)

After 15 min of filling in: pair with a buddy and compare. Where do you disagree? Why?

Teacher asks: which row revealed the most interesting cross-cultural difference?

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add an 8th row of your own choosing.
- **Tier down:** Focus on the first 4 rows; the others can be discussed orally.

Clean-up

- Tables collected — used in the Day 8 paper outline.

Project Brief

Project Brief — Module 2 Pañcabhūta (Senior)

Type: 5-page argumentative paper · **Marks:** 65 · **Due:** End of Day 10

The question

Choose ONE of the following or propose your own (with teacher approval):

1. **Should classical Indian intellectual frameworks be taught alongside modern science in mainstream science class?**
2. **Is the Sāṅkhya tanmātra-indriya symmetry a philosophical achievement that modern psychophysics later rediscovered, or an unrelated coincidence?**
3. **Does the Sāṅkhya inclusion of ākāśa as a positive category (not “absence of matter”) anticipate any question that modern field theory addresses?**
4. **Compare the role of guṇas (sattva, rajas, tamas) in Sāṅkhya with the role of Love-and-Strife in Empedocles. What does each scheme explain that the other doesn’t?**

Required elements

Your paper must include:

1. **Clear thesis statement** in the opening paragraph.
2. **At least one primary scriptural source** quoted in IAST + translation (from the RAG cache files in `.rag-cache/`).
3. **At least one secondary scholarly source** (Larson, Plofker, Bryant, or another academic source you locate).
4. **At least one cross-cultural or modern comparative source** (Empedocles, Aristotle, modern science).
5. **A steel-manned counter-argument** and your considered response to it.
6. **Works-cited page** with proper formatting (MLA or Chicago).

Format

- 5 pages (4.5–5.5 acceptable)
- Double-spaced, 12pt
- Title page with name, class, thesis statement
- IAST diacritics used correctly

Schedule

- Day 7: choose topic.
- Day 8: outline + thesis submitted.
- Day 9: draft (≥ 2 pages) shared with buddy.
- Day 10: final paper submitted.

Rubric

See `rubric.md`. Familiarise yourself BEFORE Day 8.

Self-reflection (1 paragraph, submitted with paper)

1. What did you set out to argue, and what did you actually argue?
2. What is the strongest counter-argument you encountered, and how did you respond?
3. If you had three more days, what would you research deeper?